

# THE CULT OF THE BLACK GRAIL

*Concocted by Beelzebub himself, the Black Grail is the most calamitous plague that has ever ravaged this bleak world. Not living, not dead, its victims become vessels to spread the corruption of their new master. Those depraved enough to willingly embrace this “gift” become nobles of the Order of the Fly, forming warbands and shepherding their lesser brethren to find and infect life of any kind.*

## Warband Creation

You have 700 ☉ to recruit a Cult of the Black Grail Warband for a Campaign (► see Starting a Warband). The Cult of the Black Grail are Fallen.

### Black Grail

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## Armoury Tables

Cult of the Black Grail Warbands can have the following Battlekit. Battlekit with a bullet point [•] is unique to Cult of the Black Grail Warbands and its rules can be found in the Cult of the Black Grail Battlekit section after the Armoury. (► see Battlekit in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook).

## Special Rules

The following special rules apply to a Cult of the Black Grail Warband (including any Cult of the Black Grail Variant Warbands).

- ✦ **INFECTION MARKERS:** Some Cult of the Black Grail Weapons have the INFECTION MARKERS Keyword. These Weapons cause INFECTION MARKERS (instead of BLOOD MARKERS) to be placed next to the target (► see INFECTION MARKERS ).
- ✦ **Morale:** Fighting against the Cult of the Black Grail is a terrifying prospect. Your opponent must add -1 DICE to all Morale Checks unless their Warband is of either the Court of the Seven-Headed Serpent or the Cult of the Black Grail.

**Black Grail****Infection Markers**

An **INFECTION MARKER** works in a similar way to a **BLOOD MARKER**, except that they grow and multiply over time if left untreated.

**Placing Infection Markers**

**INFECTION MARKERS** are placed next to a model in the same way as a **BLOOD MARKER**. A model may have up to six **INFECTION MARKERS** and up to six **BLOOD MARKERS** at the same time. We recommend you use different coloured dice (the more disgusting the better!) to represent **INFECTION MARKERS**.

**Using Infection Markers**

An **INFECTION MARKER** can be used in the same way as a **BLOOD MARKER** (► see Comprehensive Rules in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook.); for example, it can be spent to modify Success Rolls and Injury Rolls, and/ or to convert an Injury Roll to a Bloodbath Roll. Additionally, you can combine **BLOOD MARKERS** and **INFECTION MARKERS** to affect the same roll or to cause a Bloodbath.

**Removing Infection Markers**

Rules that allow a **BLOOD MARKER** to be removed from a model cannot be used to remove an **INFECTION MARKER** unless specifically noted otherwise.

**The Infection Spreads**

If there are one or more **INFECTION MARKERS** next to a model when the model is Activated, place 1 more **INFECTION MARKER** next to the model before it carries out any Actions.

**Plague Knight Ranks**

Each Plague Knight in a Warband can be given one of the following Plague Knight Ranks at the indicated cost in ⚰:

- ✦ **Plague Almoner** (10 ⚰): If you convert an Injury Roll into a Bloodbath Roll for an attack made by this Plague Knight, the cost in **BLOOD MARKERS** and/or **INFECTION MARKERS** of the Bloodbath Roll is reduced by 1.
- ✦ **Knight Companion of the Fly** (5 ⚰): Add +1 **DICE** to either the Ranged or the Melee Characteristic of this Plague Knight (you can choose which of the Characteristics to increase).
- ✦ **Knight of the Rotten Cross** (5 ⚰, Limit: 1): You can purchase 1 Ranged Weapon or 1 Melee Weapon from the New Antioch or Heretic Legions Armoury Tables for this model. Any stipulations that apply to the Weapon must be followed (so there is no point in taking a Weapon that can only be used by a specific model). The Weapon cannot be sold or reallocated in the Quartermaster Step of the Campaign Phase (► see Campaign in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook), but can be replaced if it is lost for any reason.

## Black Grail

### Ranged Weapons

|                      |                                     |      |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------|------|
| Blunderbuss          | Shield Combo                        | 5 ☹  |
| Bolt-Action Rifle    | Bayonet Lug                         | 10 ☹ |
| • Corruption Belcher | Limit: 2                            | 30 ☹ |
| • Infested Rifle     | Bayonet Lug                         | 15 ☹ |
| Machine Gun          | Amalgam only, Limit: 1              | 50 ☹ |
| Musket               | Bayonet Lug                         | 5 ☹  |
| Pistol               |                                     | 6 ☹  |
| • Putrid Shotgun     | Bayonet Lug, Shield Combo, Limit: 2 | 20 ☹ |
| Shotgun              | Bayonet Lug, Shield Combo           | 10 ☹ |
| • Viscera Cannon     | ELITE only, Limit: 2                | 50 ☹ |

### Melee Weapons

|                   |                      |      |
|-------------------|----------------------|------|
| Bayonet           | Shield Combo         | 2 ☹  |
| • Beelzebub's Axe | ELITE only, Limit: 1 | 30 ☹ |
| Great Hammer/Maul |                      | 10 ☹ |
| Great Sword/Axe   |                      | 12 ☹ |
| • Plague Blade    | ELITE only, Limit: 3 | 7 ☹  |
| Polearm           | Shield Combo         | 7 ☹  |
| Sword/Axe         |                      | 4 ☹  |
| Trench Club       |                      | 3 ☹  |
| Trench Knife      |                      | 1 ☹  |

### Grenades

|                     |  |      |
|---------------------|--|------|
| Gas Grenades        |  | 10 ☹ |
| • Parasite Grenades |  | 15 ☹ |

### Shields

|                      |                          |      |
|----------------------|--------------------------|------|
| • Black Grail Shield | ELITE only, Shield Combo | 20 ☹ |
| Trench Shield        | Shield Combo             | 10 ☹ |

### Armour

|                   |            |      |
|-------------------|------------|------|
| Reinforced Armour | ELITE only | 40 ☹ |
| Standard Armour   |            | 15 ☹ |

### Equipment

|                        |                                          |                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Combat Helmet          | Headgear                                 | 5 ☹            |
| • Compound Eyes Helmet | ELITE & Heralds only, Headgear, Limit: 3 | 10 ☹           |
| • Grail Devotee        | ELITE only, Limit: 2                     | 15 ☹<br>or 2 ✳ |
| Field Shrine           |                                          | 2 ✳            |
| Musical Instrument     | Limit: 1                                 | 15 ☹           |
| Troop Flag             | Limit: 1                                 | 1 ✳            |
| Unholy Trinket         | Consumable                               | 15 ☹           |

## The Cult of the Black Grail Battlekit

### Black Grail

The following Battlekit items are unique to the Cult of the Black Grail Warband. Rules for all other items are in the standard Battlekit section (► see Battlekit in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook). See the Cult of the Black Grail Special Rules section for any Weapons that have the INFECTION MARKERS Keyword.

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#### Beelzebub's Axe | 30 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 1

*With blades crafted in the form of a fly spreading its wings, this enormous axe is eternally covered with corruption and filth of Beelzebub.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords                                 |
|----------|-------|------------------------------------------|
| 2-Handed | Melee | +2 INJURY DICE, HEAVY, INFECTION MARKERS |

#### Black Grail Shield | 20 ☹ | ELITE only, Shield Combo

*This device of the Cult of the Black Grail carries the blessing of the Lord of Flies. It has a will of its own, moving to intercept any bullets or other projectiles that might impede the work of Beelzebub.*

| Type   | Range | Keywords           |
|--------|-------|--------------------|
| Shield | -     | -1 INJURY MODIFIER |

✳ **Power of the Cult of the Black Grail:** When a model with a Black Grail Shield is chosen as the target for a Ranged Attack, it can draw on the Power of the Cult of the Black Grail before the Success Roll is made for the attack. If it does so, take a Success Roll for the model with the Black Grail Shield. If the roll is a Failure, nothing happens and the attack is carried out as normal. If the roll is a Success, add -2 DICE to the roll for the Ranged Attack. If the roll is a Critical Success, the attack is automatically a Failure (do not make a Success Roll for the attack).

#### Troops Warband Entries

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Black Grail

**Compound Eyes Helmet | 10 ⬢ | ELITE & Heralds only, Headgear, Limit: 3**

*This ancient helmet fuses with its wearer, linking their nerves to its compound eyes, granting enhanced vision.*

| Type      | Range | Keywords        |
|-----------|-------|-----------------|
| Equipment | -     | NEGATE SHRAPNEL |

✦ **Enhanced Vision:** Add +1 DICE to the Success Roll of Ranged Attacks taken for a model that has a Compound Eyes Helmet.

**Corruption Belcher | 30 ⬢ | Limit: 2**

*Corruption belchers spew forth noxious gas and corrosive fumes captured from the Bolgias that divide the putrid swamps of the Eighth Circle of Hell.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords                            |
|----------|-------|-------------------------------------|
| 2-Handed | 8"    | FLAMETHROWER,<br>GAS, IGNORE ARMOUR |

**Grail Devotee | 15 ⬢ or 2 ✨ | ELITE only, Limit: 2**

*Given birth by Matagot Hags after devouring living victims whole, these diminutive thralls are driven by an unspeakable thirst for fluids tainted by the Cult of the Black Grail. They attach themselves to the nobles of the Order of the Fly, endlessly grovelling and begging for any secretion or discharge of fluid their master might be able to spare.*

| Type      | Range | Keywords |
|-----------|-------|----------|
| Equipment | -     | -        |

✦ **Grail Devotees:** Up to 2 models can have up to 2 Grail Devotees each. Add +1 INJURY MODIFIER to Injury Rolls for Melee attacks made by the model for each Grail Devotee that it has. Each Grail Devotee can be represented by a model if you wish. Place them adjacent to the model that they are following but note that Grail Devotees are not treated as models for any rules purposes, just move them out of the way if they get in the way of a “proper” model.

✦ **Jealous Obsession:** The Limit of 2 is the number of models that can have Grail Devotees; each model can have up to 2 Grail Devotees. The cost of the second Grail Devotee taken for a model is paid in ✨ instead of ⬢.

## Black Grail

### Infested Rifle | 15 ☹ | Bayonet Lug

*Armour offers little protection against the horrid, tainted bullets of this rifle, polluted by the power of Beelzebub himself. The bullets are semi-sentient, flying through the tiniest chinks in any armour.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords        |
|----------|-------|-----------------|
| 2-Handed | 18"   | ARMOUR-PIERCING |

### Parasite Grenades | 15 ☹

*Gifted from the Lord of the Flies, these grenades are filled with parasitic mind worms whose bites cause fever dreams and terrifying hallucinations. They are used to force the mortals away from the safety of defended bunkers and trenches.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords                                 |
|----------|-------|------------------------------------------|
| Grenades | 8"    | ASSAULT, IGNORE COVER, IGNORE LONG RANGE |

✳️ **Terrifying Hallucinations:** If a Parasite Grenade hits a target, after resolving the Injury Roll, you can move the target model 3". The move must be in a straight line, but can be in any direction, and can be used to make the model move within 1" of an enemy, make a retreat move, Climb, Jump, or Jump Down. The model cannot make a Diving Charge and does not count as charging if it finishes the move within 1" of an enemy model.

### Plague Blade | 7 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 3

*Carrying the viral strain of Beelzebub himself, these weapons are the terror of all mortals. Even the tiniest nick or scratch usually leads to an agonising death and eternal servitude to the Lord of Flies as a ghastly walking corpse.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords          |
|----------|-------|-------------------|
| 1-Handed | Melee | INFECTION MARKERS |

### Putrid Shotgun | 20 ☹ | Bayonet Lug, Shield Combo, Limit: 2

*Each a corroded, winged and demon-possessed cartridge filled with infected parasitic larvae, the rounds of putrid shotguns are almost impossible to avoid. This repulsive weapon is nicknamed "blunderpus" by the New Antioch troops.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords                                     |
|----------|-------|----------------------------------------------|
| 2-Handed | 12"   | +1 DICE, ASSAULT, INFECTION MARKERS, SHOTGUN |

Viscera Cannon | 50 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 2

*This heavy firearm is the most loathsome and repulsive of all the weapons in the arsenal of the Cult of the Black Grail – and that is saying something. A warrior armed with this pride of Beelzebub inserts its tubes into their own abdomen and then shoots their own corrosive fluids and innards at the enemy. It is operated by a hand crank that first builds pressure inside the user until they are at the point of bursting, and then releases the spray of viscera at their foe. The greater the amount of their own flesh the user releases, the more horrific the damage.*

| Type     | Range | Keywords       |
|----------|-------|----------------|
| 2-Handed | 24"   | +2 DICE, HEAVY |

☠ **Self Sacrifice:** If a Viscera Cannon hits a target, after resolving the Injury Roll, you can place up to 3 **BLOOD MARKERS** next to model that made the Attack (until it has a maximum of 6 markers). Then place 1 **INFECTION MARKER** next to the target for each **BLOOD MARKER** that you placed on the attacking model.

Black Grail

## Elite Warband Entries:

### ↔ The Order of the Fly ↔

#### 0-1 Lord of Tumours - Cost 130 ☹

A Cult of the Black Grail Warband must include at least 1 Lord of Tumours or 1 Plague Knight.

*A high-ranking noble officiant in the Cult of the Black Grail, the Lord of Tumours spreads filth and corruption amongst friend and foe alike. They commune with the Lord of the Flies through a trance-like ecstasy and can channel the very power of the Seventh Circle of Hell which Beelzebub rules.*

| Movement    | Ranged  | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-------------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| 6"/Infantry | +1 DICE | +4 DICE | 0      | 50mm |

#### Black Grail

**Battlekit** A Lord of Tumours can have any Battlekit from the Cult of the Black Grail Armoury Tables.

**Abilities**

- ✦ **Beelzebub's Touch:** Whenever a Melee Attack made by a Lord of Tumours causes any **BLOOD MARKERS** or **INFECTION MARKERS** to be placed on the target, place 1 extra **INFECTION MARKER** next to the target model.
- ✦ **Crushing Blows:** A Lord of Tumours can make a Crushing Blows Melee Attack instead of using any Melee Weapons that it has. If does so, it can attack twice and the Off-Hand modifier does not apply to the second attack.
- ✦ **Undead Fortitude:** Add -1 **INJURY DICE** to Injury Rolls for a Lord of Tumours unless the attack has the **FIRE** Keyword.

**Keywords** **BLACK GRAIL, ELITE, FEAR, LEADER, NEGATE GAS, STRONG, TOUGH**

#### Elite Warband Entries

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## 0-2 Plague Knights - Cost 60 ☹

A Cult of the Black Grail Warband must include either a Lord of Tumours accompanied by up to 2 Plague Knights, or, if no Lord of Tumours is taken, between 1 and 3 Plague Knights.

*Ranking lowest in the nobility of the Black Grail, these great armoured warriors were once truly depraved worshippers of Beelzebub. When the Cult of the Black Grail came for them, they willingly submitted to the authority of the Lord of Flies. As a result they retain a semblance of sentience and the ability to wield weapons as they did in life. They aspire to win favour in the eyes of Beelzebub and one day be promoted in the hierarchy of the Order of the Fly.*

| Movement    | Ranged  | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-------------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| 6"/Infantry | +0 DICE | +2 DICE | 0      | 32mm |

### Black Grail

#### Warband Creation

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Battlekit</b> | A Plague Knight can have any Battlekit from the Cult of the Black Grail Armoury Tables. It must have a suit of Armour. No restrictions apply to any other Types of Battlekit.    |
| <b>Abilities</b> | ☛ <b>Undead Fortitude:</b> Add -1 INJURY DICE to Injury Rolls for a Plague Knight unless the attack has the FIRE Keyword.<br>☛ <b>Plague Knight Ranks:</b> (► see Special Rules) |
| <b>Keywords</b>  | BLACK GRAIL, ELITE, FEAR, NEGATE GAS, STRONG                                                                                                                                     |

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## Black Grail

## 0-3 Corpse Guards - Cost 55 ☹

*Only the strongest human devotees can survive the compounding blessings of the Cult of the Black Grail. The ones that do are inducted into the ranks of the Corpse Guards, bodyguards to the nobility of the Cult of the Black Grail. If they serve with distinction, they may one day join the ranks of the Infernal nobility.*

| Movement    | Ranged  | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-------------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| 6"/Infantry | +0 DICE | +1 DICE | 0      | 32mm |

**Battlekit** A Corpse Guard can have any Battlekit from the Cult of the Black Grail Armoury Tables.

**Abilities**

- ✦ **Bodyguard:** If a friendly Cult of the Black Grail model within 1" of a Corpse Guard is hit by a Ranged Attack or Melee Attack, you can say that the Corpse Guard will take the hit. If you do so, make an Injury Roll for the Corpse Guard instead of the original target. This ability cannot be used against attacks that have the **BLAST** Keyword.
- ✦ **Parasitic Tick:** Whenever a Melee Attack made by a Corpse Guard causes any **BLOOD MARKERS** or **INFECTION MARKERS** to be placed on the target, you can remove up to 1 **BLOOD MARKER** or **INFECTION MARKER** from the attacking Corpse Guard model.
- ✦ **Undead Fortitude:** Add -1 **INJURY DICE** to Injury Rolls for a Corpse Guard unless the attack has the **FIRE** Keyword.

**Keywords** BLACK GRAIL, ELITE, FEAR, NEGATE GAS

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## —Servants of the Cult of the Black Grail—

## Grail Thralls / Fly Thralls - Cost 25 ☹

*The boons of the Cult of the Black Grail lead slowly but surely down the path of utter corruption. Only very few of the chosen can withstand the blessings of the Lord of the Flies. Most are turned into Grail Thralls, destined to join the endless legions of empty, hollowed-out and diseased husks who must obey the whims of the Cult of the Black Grail nobles for all eternity, while suffering the torment of their countless supernatural infections.*

**Thralls come in two varieties:** Grail Thralls, which have become almost impervious to pain, and Fly Thralls, controlled by the gargantuan hell-flies that have buried their proboscis deep into the central nervous system of their victims, allowing far greater mobility in exchange for less resistance to pain.

## Grail Thrall Profile

| Movement    | Ranged | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-------------|--------|---------|--------|------|
| 5"/Infantry | -      | -1 DICE | 0      | 25mm |

## Fly Thrall Profile

| Movement  | Ranged | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-----------|--------|---------|--------|------|
| 6"/Flying | -      | -1 DICE | 0      | 25mm |

**Battlekit** A Thrall cannot have any Battlekit.

**Abilities**

- ✳ **Overwhelming Horde:** A Grail Thrall or Fly Thrall can make a Melee Attack even though it does not have a Melee Weapon. In addition, add +1 DICE to the Success Roll for a Melee Attack made by a Grail Thrall or Fly Thrall for each other friendly model within 3" of the attacking model (not including the attacking model itself).
- ✳ **Undead Fortitude (Grail Thralls only):** Add -1 INJURY DICE to Injury Rolls for a Grail Thrall unless the attack has the FIRE Keyword.

**Keywords** BLACK GRAIL, FEAR, NEGATE GAS

## Black Grail

## 0-3 Hounds of the Black Grail - Cost 55 ☹

*These are parasitic carcasses of canines infested with maggots and flies spawned from the body of Beelzebub himself. Their unholy mission is to prowl No Man's Land and spread disease and pestilence in the name of their dark master.*

| Movement    | Ranged | Melee   | Armour | Base       |
|-------------|--------|---------|--------|------------|
| 8"/Infantry | -      | +1 DICE | 0      | 30 by 60mm |

**Battlekit** A Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail cannot have any Battlekit.

**Abilities**

- ☛ **Disease Carrier:** If an enemy model is Activated while it is within 1" of a Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail, place 1 **INFECTION MARKER** next to the enemy model before it carries out any Actions.
- ☛ **Frightening Speed:** Add +1 **DICE** to the Risky Success Roll for a Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail that is taking a Dash **ACTION**. In addition, do not halve the Movement Characteristic of a Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail when it stands up at the start of an Activation.
- ☛ **Infested Carcasses:** Hounds of the Black Grail models can add the **INFECTION MARKERS** Keyword to their melee attacks at a cost of +5 ☹ each.
- ☛ **Teeth & Claws:** A Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail can make a Melee Attack even though it does not have a Melee Weapon.
- ☛ **Undead Fortitude:** Add -1 **INJURY DICE** to Injury Rolls for a Hound of the Cult of the Black Grail unless the attack has the **FIRE** Keyword.

**Keywords** **BLACK GRAIL, FEAR, NEGATE GAS**

## Black Grail

## 0-4 Herald of Beelzebub - Cost 50 ☹

*Some victims of the Cult of the Black Grail suffer a far worse fate than becoming a Thrall. They are bestowed with the black honour of being melded with hell-flies, growing into a grotesque winged insect made of bloated flesh. After this torturous metamorphosis they take to the air as Herald of Beelzebub, the winged squires and scouts of the Order of the Fly. Their vestigial human bodies are still conscious as they are slowly eaten from within to be used as fuel by the Herald, all the while their warped bodies fight for the glory of Hell against their will.*

*The Herald is the vanguard in any assault of the Cult of the Black Grail, and the ear-numbing otherworldly drone of their wings strikes terror in any defender, breaking their focus and sapping their willpower. Herald wield discarded weapons contaminated with horrible worms that churn through them, which in turn infect their victims. Each diseased bullet has a sentience of its own, finding even the smallest chink in any armour, burrowing into the nervous system and liquefying the internal organs from within.*

| Movement   | Ranged  | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|------------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| 10"/Flying | +0 DICE | +0 DICE | 0      | 40mm |

**Battlekit** A Herald of Beelzebub can have any Ranged Weapon from the Cult of the Black Grail Armoury Tables. They cannot have any other Battlekit apart from a Compound Eyes Helmet or a single Grail Devotee.

**Abilities**

- ☛ **Infected Proboscis:** A Herald of Beelzebub can make a Melee Attack with the INFECTION MARKERS Keyword even though it does not have a Melee Weapon. If a Melee Attack made by a Herald of Beelzebub causes any INFECTION MARKERS to be placed on the target model, you can remove up to 1 BLOOD MARKER from the attacking Herald of Beelzebub.
- ☛ **Maddening Buzzing:** Up to 1 Herald of Beelzebub model can have the Maddening Buzzing ability at a cost of +10 ☹. Success Rolls taken for enemy models within 8" of a model with this ability become Risky Success Rolls (there is no additional effect if they are Risky Success Rolls already).

**Keywords** BLACK GRAIL, FEAR, NEGATE GAS, SKIRMISHER

## 0-1 Amalgam - Cost 140 🐉

*An Amalgam is a huge, shambling mass of dozens of bodies of infected enemy warriors, insects, mammals and any other living creatures that had the misfortune of succumbing to the agonising blessings of the Cult of the Black Grail together. These aberrations shamble across the battlefield like walking mountains of corpulent, diseased flesh, their flailing arms still wielding weapons its victims used in life. Anyone or anything unfortunate enough to be in its path is crushed into a disgusting pulp beneath its elephantine feet.*

| Movement    | Ranged  | Melee   | Armour | Base |
|-------------|---------|---------|--------|------|
| 6"/Infantry | +0 DICE | +0 DICE | 0      | 60mm |

### Battlekit

An Amalgam has six arms and has the **STRONG** Keyword, which allows it to carry a vast combination of different Ranged and Melee Weapons. It can have up to six Ranged or Melee Weapons from the Black Grail Armoury, and an Amalgam can treat two 2-Handed Weapons as 1-Handed Weapons instead of the one normally granted by the **STRONG** Keyword. Remaining 2-Handed Weapons count as two weapons towards this total. An Amalgam cannot have the same Weapon more than twice and it cannot have Grenades.

An Amalgam may have up to 1 Trench Shield in place of one of its 1-Handed Weapons, but it does not benefit from the Shield Combo rule. It cannot have any other Battlekit.

### Abilities

✦ **Six-armed Monstrosity:** The rules for making more than one Ranged or Melee Attack do not apply to an Amalgam. Instead an Amalgam can take 1 Shoot **ACTION** per Activation with each Ranged Weapon it is equipped with, and can take 1 Fight **ACTION** per Activation with each Melee Weapon it is equipped with. The Off-Hand Weapon modifier does not apply to any of its Melee Attacks.

✦ **Corpulent:** Add -2 **DICE** to Injury Rolls for any attacks that target an Amalgam model.

✦ **Trample ACTION:** An Amalgam can take a Trample **ACTION**. If it does so, it can make a Melee Attack that must target an enemy model that is Down. A Trample Melee Attack does not use a Melee Weapon and has the **IGNORE ARMOUR** Keyword.

✦ **Unstoppable:** Enemy models that are mounted on a base of 32mm or less are not allowed to make a Melee Attack when an Amalgam that is within 1" of them retreats. In addition, an Amalgam can use a normal move or a charge move if all enemy models within 1" of it are mounted on bases of 32mm or less.

### Keywords

**BLACK GRAIL, FEAR, NEGATE GAS, STRONG, TOUGH**

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## ◀—Warband Variant—▶

### Dirge of the Great Hegemon

*In the annals of the Great War two mighty Hegemons of the Cult of the Black Grail have risen: Yersinia Rex, Emperor of Pestilence, and Febris, the Rotting Bride of Beelzebub. Each was eventually destroyed, but at an unimaginable cost to the forces of the Great-Tyrant YHWH whom the Lord of the Flies seeks to overthrow. Even the great Paladin Engelier, the Sword of Heaven, died when confronting the might of a Hegemon.*

*With the ascension of a Hegemon, the hideous power of the Cult of the Black Grail is exalted. Beelzebub grows sleek and fat, and like a magnanimous king, bestows blessings and gifts upon his most favoured children. Beelzebub's insidious grip over his Grail Thralls greatly increases. They move with more grace and the exalted blessings of the Grail opens their ruined minds, allowing them to truly witness the rotting glory of the Lord of the Flies and enabling them to understand more complex weaponry. In turn, the nobles that make up the ranks of the Order of the Fly are given kingly gifts from their mighty liege.*

*Full of the ascendant power of the Cult of the Black Grail, how miserable they become when their Hegemon lord falls in battle. Each Hegemon is unique, thus when slain it can never be re-created. The ecstasy of the Plague Knights in the service of their dread ruler sinks into the deepest despair from which there is no escape. Their strain of the Cult of the Black Grail is shunned by others of their kind, and they are no longer welcome at Ekron, the city of Beelzebub. They are cast out from the Order of the Fly for their failure. The Hegemon's strain of disease continues to spread and create Thralls, but they are born into a world bereft of their sires, leaving them hopeless and desolate.*

*The eyes of the Plague Knights continuously weep cold black blood as they cry for their lost dark paradise that will never be again. The tantalising dream of a great flood of pestilence that cleanses the Earth is lost forever. Their mournful wails echo and reverberate through No Man's Land, a cry of sorrow deeper than any mortal can feel, and agonising rage of black hatred that no mortal comprehends. They compose mournful paeans to their lost Hegemon - beautiful yet disturbing songs that promise nothing but neverending death.*

*Such shattered remains of the once-mighty legions of the Hegemon take their vengeance on any opponent regardless of their allegiance, even throwing themselves at other Cult of the Black Grail warbands in futile acts of regret, trying to feel pain that would at least momentarily dull their aching feeling of loss. But no such hope exists in their eternal damnation.*

*These bands made up of the strains of fallen Hegemons' once-mighty legions form everlasting funeral processions for their dead masters. Echoing cries and dirges accompany their solemn steps, taking them from nowhere to nowhere. Their eyes are forever stained by the foul tears of the Cult of the Black Grail, and their skin turns black and sloughs off, hanging in tatters like funereal garb. They seek lost artefacts and broken shards of armour and weapons of their lost liege, fashioning disturbing and rusted jewellery from these remains where the Hegemon's power still lingers beyond the grave. Few things that haunt No Man's Land are more dangerous - or more ghastly - than these corruption-ridden echoes of the dark past, for these profane funeral processions will last until time itself is no more.*

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## DIRGE OF THE GREAT HEGEMON SPECIAL RULES

The following special rules apply to a Heretic Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband.

- ✦ **The Executor:** A Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband must include 1 Executor. The Executor uses the Plague Knight Warband Entry, except that it has a Ranged Characteristic of +1 DICE and the TOUGH Keyword, and has a cost of 80 ⬢. The Warband can still include 0-2 Plague Knights.
- ✦ **The Fallen:** A Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband cannot include a Lord of Tumours or an Amalgam.
- ✦ **The Lost:** A Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband Warband can only include 0-2 Hounds of the Cult of the Black Grail and can only include 0-2 Herald of Beelzebub.
- ✦ **The Bereaved:** The Grail Thralls or Fly Thralls in a Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband are called the Bereaved. They have a Ranged Characteristic of +0 DICE and a cost of 30 ⬢, and can have Ranged Weapons, Grenades, a Musical Instrument or a Troop Flag from the Cult of the Black Grail Armoury.
- ✦ **Dishonoured:** Models in a Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband cannot have Beelzebub's Axe or a Black Grail Shield.
- ✦ **Hegemon's Last Blessing:** Putrid Shotguns in this Warband have a Limit of 3, and Viscera Cannon have a Limit of 3 and do not have the ELITE only stipulation.
- ✦ **Hegemon's Will:** Using the remnants of the lingering power of a fallen Hegemon, a Plague Knight of the Warband can directly command a nearby Bereaved. An Executor or Plague Knight in a Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband can take a Command Bereaved ACTION. If it does so, you can remove any number of INFECTION MARKERS from enemy models. For each INFECTION MARKER you remove, you can then carry out one of the following Commands with a Bereaved (Grail Thrall or Fly Thrall) that is within 18" of the model taking the Command Bereaved ACTION. A Bereaved cannot be given more than 1 Command each Turn, but carrying out a Command does not stop it from also being Activated in the same Turn (before or after the Command was issued).
  - ✦ **Charge Command:** The Bereaved carries out a charge move.
  - ✦ **Fight Command:** The Bereaved carries out a Melee Attack.
  - ✦ **Move Command:** The Bereaved carries out a normal move (it cannot Retreat).
  - ✦ **Shoot Command:** The Bereaved carries out a Ranged Attack.



## Black Grail

## DIRGE OF THE GREAT HEGEMON ARMOURY & BATTLEKIT

The following pieces of Battlekit are available to a Dirge of the Great Hegemon Warband.

### Broken Crown | 25 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 1

*Made from the twisted and torn remains of their Hegemon's shattered armour, this crown of barbs and thorns is a constant reminder to the Mourners of their failure.*

| Type | Range | Keywords |
|------|-------|----------|
|------|-------|----------|

|           |   |   |
|-----------|---|---|
| Equipment | - | - |
|-----------|---|---|

✦ **Locus of Despair:** Each time the model with the Broken Crown is Activated, before carrying out any ACTIONS with the model, place 1 INFECTION MARKER next to each enemy model within 1" of the model with the Broken Crown.

### Urn of the Bitter Ashes | 40 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 1

*This black urn contains ashes from the burned body of the fallen Hegemon, which still retain a faint echo of its hateful will. Fragments swirl and churn in the air, and sinister whispers emanate from within.*

| Type | Range | Keywords |
|------|-------|----------|
|------|-------|----------|

|           |   |   |
|-----------|---|---|
| Equipment | - | - |
|-----------|---|---|

✦ **Sinister Whispers:** Add -1 DICE to the roll for Ranged Attacks that target a model that has the Urn of Bitter Ashes or that is within 3" of the model with the Urn of Bitter Ashes.